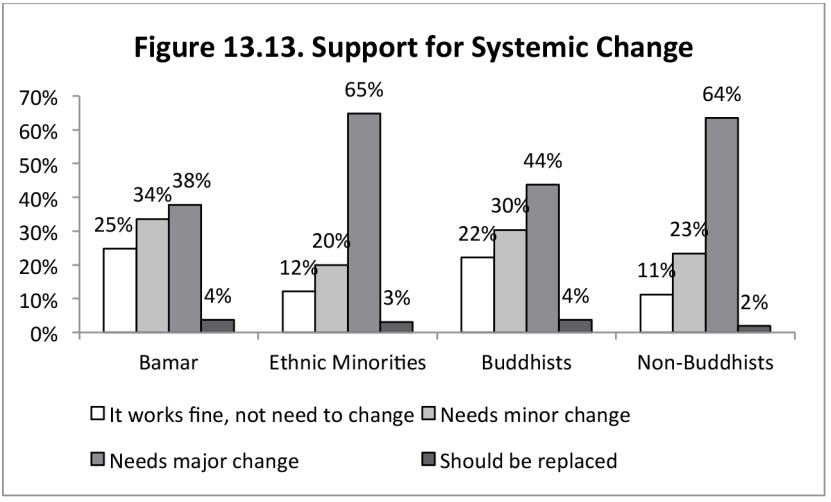
Minorities also differ from the majority in that they also support broader change in the political system. Respondents were asked the following: "Compared with other systems in the world, would you say our system of government works fine as it is, needs minor change, needs major change, or should be replaced?" While minorities join other Myanmar citizens in calling for change, close to two-thirds of both ethnic and religious minorities believe that the system needs "major" change. Bamar/Buddhists also concur change is needed, but not to the same extent and breadth as minority communities, as shown in Figure 13.13.



Myanmar citizens want change, but they do not necessarily want the system replaced altogether. Only a small share of all the communities reported selecting to replace the system. The ABS findings suggest that support for change is within the current system, even if there are some citizens who would like this change to be substantive. Myanmar citizens in general are also not inclined to use violence for their political causes. As Figure 13.14 shows, only a small minority, with a slightly higher share of ethnic minorities, is willing to use force. These results suggest that if change can be implemented within the system, this can have important implications for reducing conflict, especially violent conflict, which is only supported by a small share of the population.